

Frond ➤ Fern leaves are called fronds. These are usually divided into smaller sections, which increases the leaf's surface area so it can capture more sunlight. Fronds not only carry out photosynthesis, using the energy from sunlight to make food for the fern, but they are also important for reproduction.

Pinna ➤ Each small segment of a fern frond growing from the central stalk, or rachis, is called a pinna.

What is a fern?

Ferns are nonflowering plants that do not produce seeds. Instead, they reproduce using tiny spores, which are carried on the wind. Fern leaves are known as fronds, and they grow from underground stems. Spores are made on the underside of fronds.

Male fern

Fiddlehead ➤ New fronds develop as tightly curled spirals called fiddleheads, which unfurl as the leaf grows.

Root ➤ The roots of ferns are very similar to those of flowering plants. They absorb water and nutrients from the soil and help anchor the fern into the ground.